Shipping, Delivery and Missing Parcels Policy

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MaplePaw is a fictional physical-goods merchant. Every commitment, time limit, delivery rule and example below is an independently designed test rule. This document provides merchant-side delivery procedures; it is not an official carrier policy, PayPal evidence standard or determination of liability.

Contents

MP-DEL-01. Delivery eligibility and address verification

MP-DEL-02. Delivery charges and displayed estimates

MP-DEL-03. Fulfilment events and carrier handover

MP-DEL-04. Tracking updates and temporary gaps

MP-DEL-05. Split shipments and partial receipt

MP-DEL-06. Delivery locations and signatures

MP-DEL-07. Delivered status but customer reports non-receipt

MP-DEL-08. Stalled, missing or lost shipments

MP-DEL-09. Incorrect addresses and customer changes

MP-DEL-10. Failed attempts, returns to sender and refusals

MP-DEL-11. Remedies for established fulfilment failures

MP-DEL-12. Damage during transit

MP-DEL-13. Delivery evidence package

MP-DEL-14. Later delivery after a remedy

MP-DEL-15. Delivery review examples and boundaries

MP-DEL-01. Delivery eligibility and address verification

Delivery is offered to Canadian residential and business addresses that pass the storefront's checkout eligibility check. The test storefront does not deliver to post-office boxes, international addresses or freight-forwarding services. These are fictional service restrictions and do not describe the service area of a real retailer.

Customers review the complete destination, including unit number, street, municipality, province and postal code, before confirming an order. MaplePaw preserves the confirmed address and any subsequently approved change. The billing address is not automatically the delivery address. A delivery claim must be reviewed against the destination of the actual disputed transaction.

If the merchant modifies an address, it records the customer request or the reason for a carrier-format normalization. Changing a unit number or destination is a material change requiring customer confirmation. Routine formatting, such as capitalizing a postal code, does not create a new destination.

MP-DEL-02. Delivery charges and displayed estimates

Standard delivery is free when the discounted merchandise subtotal is at least CAD 60.00, before tax and before store-credit redemption. Otherwise, the standard delivery fee is CAD 6.50. Credits used as payment do not reduce the qualifying merchandise subtotal. These values are synthetic configuration choices.

MaplePaw does not impose a second standard delivery fee simply because it chooses to split an order into multiple parcels. Any premium service selected by the customer is separately disclosed at checkout. A charge not shown in the confirmed total is reviewed under MP-PAY-08.

The normal estimated transit period is two to five business days after carrier acceptance. This is an estimate, not proof of delivery and not a promise of arrival on a particular calendar date. A carrier label created without an acceptance scan does not start the transit estimate. If a specific guaranteed delivery date is offered in a future fixture, the offer must be preserved and evaluated separately.

MP-DEL-03. Fulfilment events and carrier handover

Each shipment record links the order ID, package ID, included line items and quantities, carrier name, tracking number, destination and relevant timestamps. A picking record shows warehouse preparation. A label event shows that a label was created. Neither event alone establishes physical handover to a carrier.

Carrier acceptance or an equivalent authenticated handover record is the normal evidence that transit began. If the carrier feed is unavailable, MaplePaw may seek a manifest or warehouse handover record, but must describe its source and limits. Staff must not manufacture an acceptance event from an anticipated ship date.

A fulfilment confirmation is sent when the parcel leaves the warehouse. If an earlier email was sent in error, support corrects the customer-facing status and identifies the remaining uncertainty. Payment capture is reconciled with shipped items under MP-PAY-02.

MP-DEL-04. Tracking updates and temporary gaps

Tracking events may arrive late, repeat, or appear out of order. The investigation compares event time with ingestion time and keeps both when available. An older scan received later should not automatically overwrite a newer delivery event. Carrier outages do not establish that a parcel was lost.

If no acceptance scan appears within two business days after label creation, MaplePaw checks its handover records and asks the fulfilment team for clarification. If transit has begun but no further event appears for three business days, support opens a carrier enquiry. These targets trigger investigation, not an automatic denial or automatic finding of loss.

Customers may report a concern before these targets. Staff may investigate earlier where there is an obvious address error, damage scan or urgent product concern. A customer should not be instructed to wait indefinitely merely because a tracking number exists.

MP-DEL-05. Split shipments and partial receipt

An order may contain several packages with separate tracking numbers. MaplePaw identifies which items were placed in each package and communicates the split to the customer. A delivered package proves only the arrival of its recorded contents; it does not establish receipt of items assigned to another package.

When the customer receives one of two parcels, support checks the second parcel's status instead of rejecting the claim as delivered. When a listed item is absent from a delivered parcel, the missing-item issue is reviewed under MP-RET-05 and fulfilment records are inspected.

A refund or replacement for a missing parcel covers the items allocated to that parcel and any remedy-related delivery allocation specified in MP-DEL-11. Staff must not refund the entire order by default if other items were delivered and retained. Conversely, a partial delivery must not be described as complete delivery.

MP-DEL-06. Delivery locations and signatures

A carrier may leave a standard parcel at the confirmed door, a secure parcel room or a staffed reception area where permitted by the selected service. MaplePaw does not promise a signature for every shipment. If signature service was expressly purchased, staff verify whether the signature requirement was actually fulfilled.

A tracking event stating delivered is relevant but must be assessed with the destination and service details. A photograph may show a location without establishing that it is the correct unit. A recipient name or signature may require clarification if the customer denies knowing that person.

Support asks whether an authorized household member, reception desk or parcel locker received the package, while avoiding instructions that require unsafe contact with strangers. Where a locker is involved, staff request the access or collection record if available. Absence of a signature is not automatically a failed delivery when the chosen service did not require one.

MP-DEL-07. Delivered status but customer reports non-receipt

A customer reporting non-receipt after a delivered scan should provide the order ID, missing package or items, confirmed address and approximate time they checked. MaplePaw first reviews the carrier event, delivery location, package allocation, address match and any available photograph or recipient record.

Support asks the customer to check ordinary safe locations and authorized recipients. A preferred report target is seven calendar days after the delivered event so evidence can be collected promptly. A later report is still reviewed; the target is not a universal forfeiture deadline.

MaplePaw opens a carrier enquiry when location or recipient evidence is unclear. If the evidence shows delivery to the wrong address, the remedy follows MP-DEL-11. If evidence supports delivery to the correct location but receipt remains disputed, the case requires human review. It must not be automatically labelled theft, fraud or successful fulfilment from the scan alone.

MP-DEL-08. Stalled, missing or lost shipments

A shipment remaining in transit beyond the upper end of its two-to-five-business-day estimate is reviewed for weather, depot exceptions, address issues and missing events. Support gives the customer the known facts and the next follow-up date. The estimate is not restarted each time the customer contacts support.

For this test policy, a parcel may be treated as operationally lost when the carrier confirms loss, or when it has remained undelivered for ten business days after authenticated carrier acceptance and a documented enquiry yields no reliable delivery evidence. A supervisor approves the latter determination. This is a merchant remedy threshold, not an external dispute standard.

An operational-loss finding supports replacement or refund of the missing items under MP-DEL-11. If the acceptance date is absent, staff investigate warehouse handover and cannot calculate the ten-day threshold as if the label date were acceptance. The absence of a trustworthy start date may itself justify escalation.

MP-DEL-09. Incorrect addresses and customer changes

If the merchant ships to a destination different from the customer's confirmed address, MaplePaw bears the synthetic policy responsibility for correcting that fulfilment error. It must not blame the customer using the wrong merchant-entered address. The original confirmation and shipment label are retained together.

If the customer supplied an incomplete or incorrect address, support attempts correction or interception where possible. A successful redirection requires a recorded updated destination. If the package is returned, the customer may choose reshipment to a validated address or a refund under MP-RET-08. Additional delivery fees require advance disclosure and approval.

When the customer changes an address after dispatch, the merchant cannot promise that the carrier will reroute the parcel. It explains the outcome of any request. A disputed redirection made by an unknown person may involve MP-PAY-04 account security as well as delivery review.

MP-DEL-10. Failed attempts, returns to sender and refusals

A carrier may record attempted delivery, inaccessible property, recipient refusal or return to sender. An attempt is not completed delivery. Support checks whether the carrier provided a collection option or later attempt and whether the customer was notified.

An uncollected or refused parcel that returns to MaplePaw is handled as a return to sender, with inspection and refund reconciliation under MP-RET-08. A valid customer cancellation before processing must not be reclassified as a voluntary refusal merely because the carrier later returned the package.

A package being sent back is not proof that a refund was issued. Staff must check the actual refund transaction. If the return destination was incorrect due to merchant instructions, the customer is not required to pay a second return fee to correct that error.

MP-DEL-11. Remedies for established fulfilment failures

For verified merchant misdelivery or an operationally lost parcel, MaplePaw offers one replacement shipment or a refund for the affected items, subject to stock availability and customer preference. A replacement is at no added standard delivery cost. If the customer chooses a refund, the associated item tax is included.

If the entire order is undelivered, any original delivery fee is refunded. If only part is undelivered, the original standard fee is refunded only when the delivered remainder would independently have qualified for free standard delivery at checkout, or when the remaining paid service was not provided. Otherwise, support explains the retained fee and escalates ambiguous cases. This rule is specific to a partial fulfilment failure, not a voluntary partial return.

A replacement is a new linked fulfilment record rather than an alteration of the original tracking history. Staff obtain confirmation of the replacement address before dispatch. Sending another parcel without customer acceptance does not automatically resolve an open payment-provider dispute.

MP-DEL-12. Damage during transit

Customers receiving a crushed, leaking or visibly damaged package should stop using any item whose safety is uncertain. Where practical, they retain packaging and provide photographs of the exterior, contents and shipping label. Unsafe items need not be mailed back without instructions.

MaplePaw checks which items were damaged and whether the product remains usable. A dent in an outer carton alone may not establish damage to all items inside. A torn food seal, leaking can or broken accessory is reviewed under MP-RET-05 and MP-RET-07.

The customer-facing remedy must not depend on the merchant first obtaining carrier reimbursement. Carrier recovery is a separate internal process. Staff record the same loss consistently so a delivery-damage refund and a product-defect refund do not reimburse the same item twice.

MP-DEL-13. Delivery evidence package

A merchant evidence package may include carrier name and tracking number, authenticated tracking history, confirmed destination, package contents, handover record, delivery photograph, signature information where applicable, customer messages and enquiry results. Each included record needs a source, collection time and explanation of its relevance.

The package must state whether evidence demonstrates shipment, attempted delivery or completed delivery. Staff must not describe a label receipt as proof of delivery or claim a signature exists when the service did not obtain one. Conflicting records are disclosed and investigated.

An evidence package generated from this policy is merchant material. The permitted fields, attachments, privacy rules and response action for an external dispute must be checked separately against the live provider requirements. This document deliberately supplies no promise that a tracking number is sufficient to win a dispute.

MP-DEL-14. Later delivery after a remedy

If the original parcel arrives after MaplePaw issued a refund or replacement, support contacts the customer with a clear account of what happened. Where safe and practical, MaplePaw may provide a prepaid label for the surplus goods or permit the customer to keep them. It does not silently create a new payment charge.

Any proposed additional purchase requires fresh customer consent and a separate order record. A prior delivery authorization is not authorization to recharge a refunded loss. If an external dispute has also credited the customer, MP-PAY-10 governs reconciliation and the record must not assume that the credit is final until its status is verified.

Late carrier scans are appended to the case history. They do not erase the earlier investigation, the date a remedy was justified or the evidence available when a decision was made. Evaluation systems should assess the recommendation against the facts known at that time.

MP-DEL-15. Delivery review examples and boundaries

Example A: A label was created on Monday, no acceptance scan exists, and the customer complains on Thursday. The correct next step is a handover investigation under MP-DEL-03 and MP-DEL-04; the parcel cannot yet be called delivered or assigned a ten-day loss clock.

Example B: Two parcels belong to an order. Parcel one contains litter and is delivered; parcel two contains food and remains missing. Support evaluates the food parcel separately under MP-DEL-05 and does not use the litter tracking number as proof that the food arrived.

Example C: Tracking says delivered, but the photograph depicts a different building and the label matches the customer's address. Human review investigates probable misdelivery under MP-DEL-07. The tracking word alone does not settle the case.

Example D: A carrier confirms loss before the ordinary ten-business-day operational threshold. MP-DEL-08 permits a loss remedy without forcing the customer to wait until day ten. The confirmation source and the affected package contents remain necessary.